



Civil Unrest: Rules Handbook

A Game of Fragile Stability

Objective

In Civil Unrest (1 to 4 players), you play as the leader of a nation navigating modern crises. Your goal is to survive politically, economically, socially as long as possible. The game ends when one player remains under the collapse threshold. Collapse happens when a player reaches 100 and is eliminated from the game.

Setup

- Unfold the Civil Unrest board in the center.
- Each player starts at 0 on the Unrest Meter (a score of 0–100 on a sliding scale).
- Use the pencil and paper to keep track of the player's scores as they go up and down based on gaining and losing points through landing on a Circles and the additional points added, removed or identified on the card.
- Place the event cards on the sides according to color.
- All players place their pawn on the START space and begin from there.
- Select who begins with each person rolling the dice and the person who rolls highest amount starts. (If two people roll the same amount, the person who matched the other will start.)
- No player can go into negative points. (Any points that would put them in the negative would simply reset the score to 0).

How Points Work

All unrest is tracked using pencil and paper as is related to a player's score/Unrest Meter (0–100) located in four spots on the board. You must add unrest points when required unless a card negates, reduces, or offsets the score/Unrest Meter. Players can not go into negative points, so players can not achieve negative unrest (capped at 0).

1. Roll Dice: Move forward (in a zig-zag manner) the number of spaces based on the number of the rolled dice.

2. Resolve the Board Space:

- Each circle/space has a color (category) and point value.



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- When landing, draw the top card from the corresponding color deck.

3. The Card:s Additonal Points:

- Add, subtract, multiply or use the points associated with the card as instructed to your point score/Unrest Meter. The term on the card (Use Value of Circle) is simply the use of the space/circle value so no additional points are added, multiplied or subtraced. Some cards might have a +/- or multiplier on the card. The minus can be used to reduce the players score/Unrest Meter value. (For example if the space value is +4 and your card says -2, the unrest meter will go up by two points, so the player's score/Unrest Meter will gain 2 points. If the card is Multitplier by 2 and the space value says +5, the layer's score/Unrest Meter will go up by 10 points.)
- If the card has a multiplier, apply it to the board value first.
- If the card is a reform or token-reducing card, reduce your total unrest by that amount.
- If the card says (Use Value of Circle), no additional points besides the circle/space value.

Card Types

Color	Category	Function
Green	Economic Pressure	Adds unrest through debt, inflation, labor strikes
Yellow	Natural Disasters & Climate	Adds unrest via destruction, forced migration, supply disruption
Blue	Civil Discord & Identity Politics	Adds unrest from protests, censorship, violence
Purple	Global Influence & Interference	Adds or shifts unrest based on international sabotage or support
Orange	Demographics & Immigration	Adds unrest via population stressors or social strain
Red	Reform & Resource Tokens	Reduces unrest, allows players to regain control or reform



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Reform Mechanics

Red cards are rare but powerful. If you land on a red space or draw a red card, it may reduce your unrest, prevent collapse, or offer strategic relief. Some reform cards may be held and played later — if they say so.

Landing on an Civil Unrest logo in the game also offers relief should a card be selected that says (Use Value of Circle) as no points are associated with these circles.

Collapse & Elimination

If a player's Unrest Meter reaches 100 or more, their government collapses and they are eliminated from the game.

Victory Conditions

✓ Standard Victory: Be the last player whose score/Unrest Meter has not reached 100.

■ Reform Victory (Optional Rule): If a player successfully reduces their unrest to under 20 (negative numbers don't count) by drawing 3 red reform cards in a row, they may declare a Reform Victory and immediately win the game.

🔥 Tyrant Victory (Optional Rule): If a player adds 25 in 3 within three turns in a row, they may declare a Tyrant Victory and immediately win the game.

Optional Rules

- Crisis Mode: Every 5 rounds, all players must draw a random Yellow card (climate/disaster).
- Two Dice Economy: Allow players to roll two dice, using either total or highest die only to move, adding strategic pacing.
- Player Sabotage: Purple cards may allow unrest to be transferred or forced onto others.
- If the Civil Unrest logo appears on the back of the card next to the situation, the player may pass the card to the next player without gaining any points from it.

Closing Comments



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Civil Unrest is more than a game; it is a reflection.

This project was created to acknowledge the tension between collapse and reform, between silence and resistance. While it draws from real-world events with strategy and satire, its deeper intent is to serve as a reminder of the human cost of injustice and the importance of protesting and speaking out when systems and leaders fail.

Society often does terrible things to its own. Through censorship, corruption, exploitation, or neglect, populations can suffer at the hands of those in power who abandon their duty to represent people honorably. History also teaches us that change comes when people refuse to accept injustice as normal. Protest, resistance, and civil disobedience can be acts of destruction, but this destruction is born from the hopelessness forced upon them.

Let this game stand as a tribute to those who fight for reform, those who have suffered from injustice, those who spoke up when it was inconvenient, and those who refuse to sit still while the world unravels.

Play boldly. Remember deeply.